THE GATHERING PLACE

Welcome

You're in.

Welcome to The Gathering Place.

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I know that sounds simple. But I've been thinking about this for a long time, and I don't say it lightly. You're not just a member of a club. You're part of the founding cohort — the people who will shape what this becomes before it becomes anything public. That matters to me.

Here's what I want you to know going in: there's no curriculum here. No weekly accountability check-in, no scorecards, no structured agenda. What there is: a space designed to make you better just by being in it. People who operate at a level where you won't want to waste their time. A studio to capture whatever you're building. And me, when you want me.

The rest of this welcome package covers the practical details — the location calendar, how the studio works, the culture principles, and how to reach me. Read it at your own pace.

The only thing I'll ask is this: show up. Not to perform. Just to be there. The room will do the rest.

I'll see you soon.

With genuine excitement,

Drew Dudley

YOU'RE IN

What Happens Now

YOUR FIRST VISIT

Your membership activates when you arrive at your first location. There's no formal onboarding, no intake process. The culture is simple enough that you'll understand it within the first hour of being there.

The one thing worth knowing before you arrive: come with something you're working on. Not to present it — just to have it in the room with you. The conversations that happen in this kind of environment tend to accelerate things that are already in motion.

BOOKING SPACE

Reach out to Drew directly to book your time at any of the properties. The model is intentionally informal — 3 to 5 people in the space at once is the ideal. No formal calendar system yet; a text or email works fine.

BRINGING GUESTS

You can bring up to 3 guests for your own retreats or programs. You arrange the terms and pricing with your guests directly — the space is yours. Let Drew know in advance so the house is set up properly.

THE STUDIO

The professional video studio is available at every location. You don't need to book in advance — just let Drew or the studio partner know what you're filming and when. If you're not sure what to film, that's a good conversation to have with Drew when you arrive.

YOUR 5 QUESTIONS

Each visit, you'll be asked 5 brief questions on camera for The Gathering Place's social content. These are short, thoughtful, unrehearsed — Drew's style. Don't prepare for them. Just answer them.

REACHING DREW

Email is best: **drew@dayoneleadership.com**

He responds to everything. He just might take a day.

HOW WE ARE TOGETHER

The Principles

These aren't rules. They're the culture. The difference is that rules create compliance; culture creates belonging.

No performance required.

You don't have to be "on." Nobody here needs you to be impressive. Leave the stage persona at the door.

Pause before answering.

One beat of reflection before speaking. Drew has trained himself to do this for years and says it made him "so much smarter and clearer." Try it.

Ask more than you answer.

The most interesting people in any room are the ones who want to know more than they want to be known.

Don't speak for more than 90 seconds straight before 5pm.

A nudge, not a rule. Smart people can fill every room. This slows things down enough for something unexpected to surface.

> THE "AM I CRAZY" ROOM / CHAIR
>
> Every location has a designated spot. If someone is in it, it means: *I have an idea I want someone to hear*. Sit across from them and you've agreed to listen first. You don't get to spew your ideas at anyone unless you're in the chair and they've chosen to come to you. Nobody gets ambushed. Nobody wanders in by accident.

Interaction signals outside your room tell people what kind of presence you're open to. Respect them. Use them. There's no social obligation to be social.

By the fire, none of the above applies. You can just be.

2026 – 2027

Where We'll Be

The calendar below covers the full founding year and the 2027 winter residency. Locations rotate — from the Toronto base to the Kawarthas cottage, a winter in Barbados, and eventually Cape Breton. Each location has a different energy. The rotation is intentional.

PERIOD	LOCATION	REGION	NOTES
Feb 15–20, 2026	Forest Hill, Toronto	Toronto, Ontario	*Pilot week. Invite-only drop-in. The first real gathering — proving the concept in a room before anything goes public.*
April – mid May 2026	Toronto (Permanent Home)	Toronto, Ontario	*A property Drew made an offer on as of early 2026. If the offer comes through, this becomes the base of operations.*
May – October 2026	The Kawarthas	Kawarthas, Ontario	*A cottage his family lost to bankruptcy 20 years ago that he swore he would one day buy back. It became available.*
November 2026	The Icon, Toronto	Toronto, Ontario	*Return to the city for late fall.*
January – March 2027	Barbados	Barbados	*A property Drew has access to. The winter residency.*
TBD	Cape Breton, Nova Scotia	Cape Breton Island, Nova Scotia	*A property on a cliff overlooking the ocean outside Chéticamp. Planned as the permanent inner-circle home for founding members.*

To book time at a location, email Drew directly at **drew@dayoneleadership.com**. Dates and availability are managed informally — there's no booking portal. A quick message is all it takes.

PROFESSIONAL VIDEO PRODUCTION

The Studio

Every Gathering Place location includes access to a professionally managed video studio. This is not a corner with a ring light. It's proper lighting, sound, and setup — managed by a studio partner Drew has already arranged.

WHAT YOU CAN FILM

- **Keynote recordings** — Full presentations filmed properly for your portfolio or licensing reel
- **Short-form social content** — Reels, LinkedIn videos, thought leadership clips
- **Course or program material** — Evergreen content for any online program you're building
- **Speaker demo content** — New material for your speaker reel
- **Client-facing content** — Video proposals, introductions, follow-up messages

HOW IT WORKS

Let Drew or the studio partner know what you want to film and when. No formal booking system — an email or text the day before is fine. If you arrive without a plan, that's fine too; the best ideas usually come out of a conversation in the space.

Production support (editing, colour correction, export for social) is included in the studio partnership for basic social content. For more involved production work, Drew can connect you directly with the studio partner to discuss scope and timeline.

WHAT TO BRING

- A rough idea of what you want to say — even a few bullet points is enough
- Your usual speaking wardrobe (the studio lighting works best with solid colours; avoid busy patterns)
- Any props, slides, or visual assets you want to reference on camera

Most members leave their first studio session surprised by how much they got done in a few hours. The setup removes all the friction — you just have to show up and talk.